

FREEZING AND COLD STORAGE

Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why do we blanch vegetables before freezing them?

FREEZING AND COLD STORAGE

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To stop enzyme actions that cause loss of flavor and color

FUN FACT

Blanching helps keep frozen veggies fresh and tasty longer!

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables

FREEZING AND COLD STORAGE

Tweens (10–14)

Q

What temperature should your freezer be to store foods safely?

FREEZING AND COLD STORAGE

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ANSWER

0°F (-18°C) or below

FUN FACT

Freezing food at the right temperature keeps it safe and yummy for months.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables

FREEZING AND COLD STORAGE

Tweens (10–14)

Q

What happens if frozen food gets freezer burn?

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ANSWER

The food becomes dry, tough, and develops off flavors

FUN FACT

Freezer burn dries out food and changes its taste, but it's still safe to eat.

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood

FREEZING AND COLD STORAGE

Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why should you remove as much air as possible when packaging food for the freezer?

FREEZING AND COLD STORAGE

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To prevent oxidation and freezer burn

FUN FACT

Less air means your frozen food stays fresh and tastes better longer.

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood

FREEZING AND COLD STORAGE

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Q

What is the best type of bag to use for freezing seafood?

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ANSWER

Heavy-duty polyethylene freezer bags

FUN FACT

Special freezer bags help keep the seafood fresh and freezer burn-free.

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood

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Q

Which foods do NOT freeze well and can get mushy or lose flavor?

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ANSWER

Lettuce, cucumbers, and cream sauces

FUN FACT

Some foods don't freeze well because their water content changes texture when frozen.

Source: SP 50-766 Foods that do not freeze well

FREEZING AND COLD STORAGE

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Q

How long can most frozen fruits and vegetables keep high quality in the freezer?

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ANSWER

8 to 12 months

FUN FACT

Frozen fruits and veggies are best eaten within a year for the best taste and nutrition.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables

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What should you do if the power goes out and your freezer stops running?

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ANSWER

Keep the freezer door closed to keep food frozen longer

FUN FACT

A full freezer stays cold longer if the door stays closed-don't open it too much!

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables

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Why do vegetables need to be thawed carefully and not warmed above 40°F before refreezing?

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ANSWER

To avoid harmful bacteria growth

FUN FACT

Bacteria can grow if thawed veggies get too warm, making the food unsafe to eat.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables

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Q

What is the main reason to label frozen food packages with date and content?

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ANSWER

To avoid wasting food by knowing how long it has been stored

FUN FACT

Labeling helps you eat food before it loses quality or goes bad.

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood

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What happens to water inside food during repeated freezing and thawing cycles in the freezer?

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ANSWER

Water moves to the surface, making large ice crystals and causing dehydration

FUN FACT

Big ice crystals hurt food texture and cause freezer burn over time!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood

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Which is a good way to protect fish and shellfish from freezer burn after freezing?

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ANSWER

Glazing with a thin layer of ice before packaging

FUN FACT

Glazing adds a protective ice coat to keep seafood fresh in the freezer.

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood

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What happens if you overfill glass jars for freezing food?

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ANSWER

The jar may break because water expands as it freezes

FUN FACT

Water expands when frozen, so jars need space on top to avoid breaking!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood

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Q

Why should you store root vegetables like carrots and potatoes in high humidity for cold storage?

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ANSWER

To keep them from drying out

FUN FACT

Moist air helps roots stay crisp instead of shriveling up.

Source: OSU winter crop storage guide

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Why must some vegetables be stored apart from others in a root cellar?

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ANSWER

Because some release gases that spoil nearby veggies

FUN FACT

Potatoes release gases that can make apples taste bad-keep them separated!

Source: OSU winter crop storage guide

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What is the best way to freeze seafood in smaller portions for easy thawing?

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ANSWER

Wrap each piece tightly and freeze individually in a master bag

FUN FACT

Freezing seafood in small packs lets you thaw only what you need!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood

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If you freeze food in a container with a lot of empty space, what helps protect the food inside?

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ANSWER

Add fresh water after freezing to top off the container

FUN FACT

Topping off containers with water keeps food from drying and protects it!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood

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What kitchen tool is best for removing oxygen while packaging food for freezing?

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ANSWER

Vacuum sealing machine

FUN FACT

Vacuum sealing helps keep air out and your food tasting fresh!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood

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Q

Why is it important to store frozen packages close together in the freezer?

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ANSWER

It helps keep the temperature steady and freezing more efficient

FUN FACT

Keeping packages close saves energy and keeps food evenly frozen.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables

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Q

If vegetables freeze without blanching first, what can happen to their quality?

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ANSWER

They may lose flavor, color, and texture faster

FUN FACT

Blanching stops bad changes that happen in frozen veggies.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables